

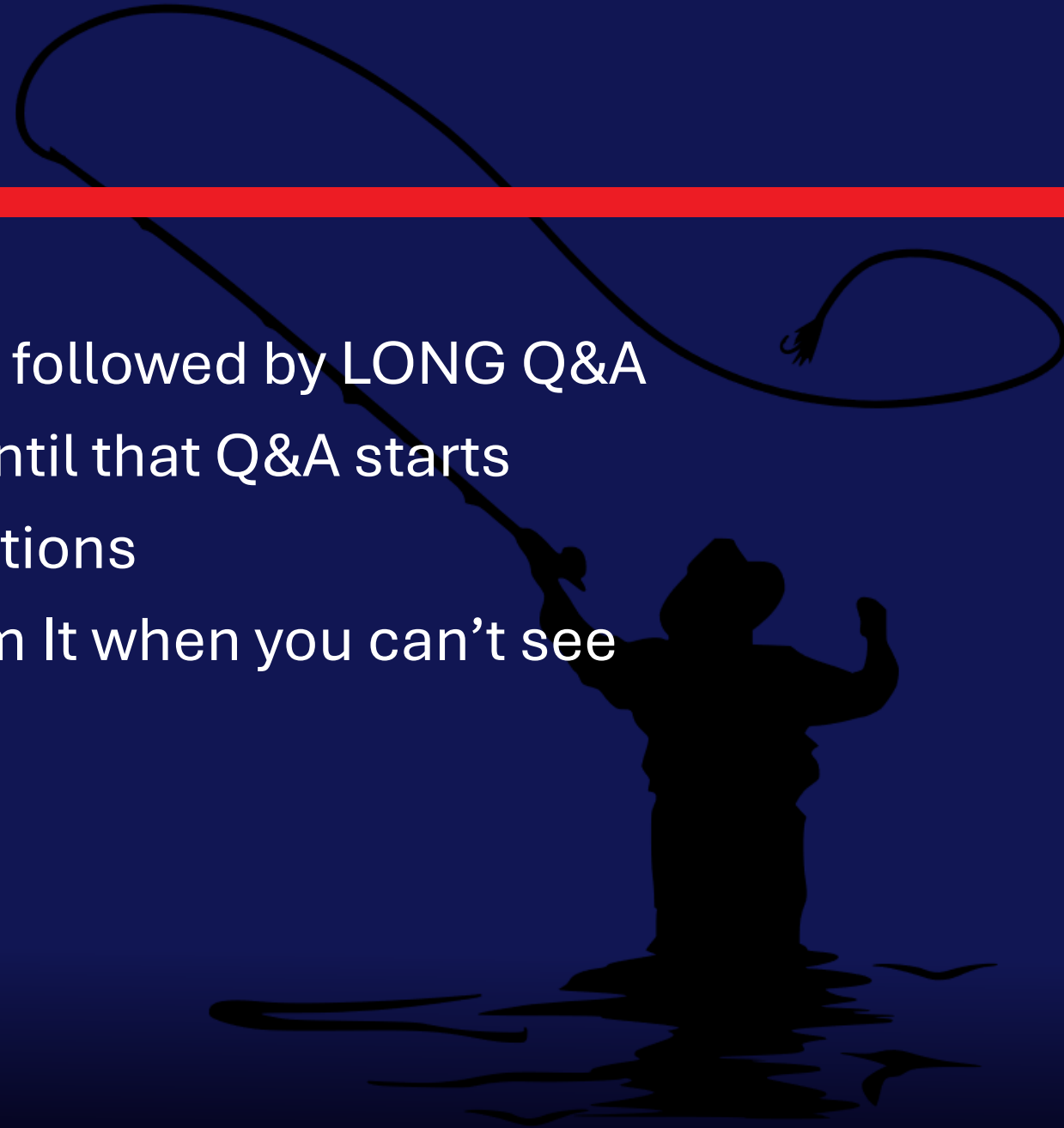
From Meh to Meaningful

A Practical Guide to Microsoft Secure Score



Attention

- ◆ MMS sessions are 60-75 minutes followed by LONG Q&A
- ◆ Please hold detailed questions until that Q&A starts
- ◆ Feel free to ask clarification questions
- ◆ Remind the speakers to use Zoom It when you can't see



Speakers



Maurice Daly

Senior Security Architect



[in/MauriceDaly](https://www.linkedin.com/in/MauriceDaly)



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Security Evangelist



[in/CarrieCookSecurity](https://www.linkedin.com/in/CarrieCookSecurity)

Can't see our slides? Can't hear? Need to repeat the question? Call us out!



Your Secure Score Value

Come on.. We know there are numbers out there..

Agenda

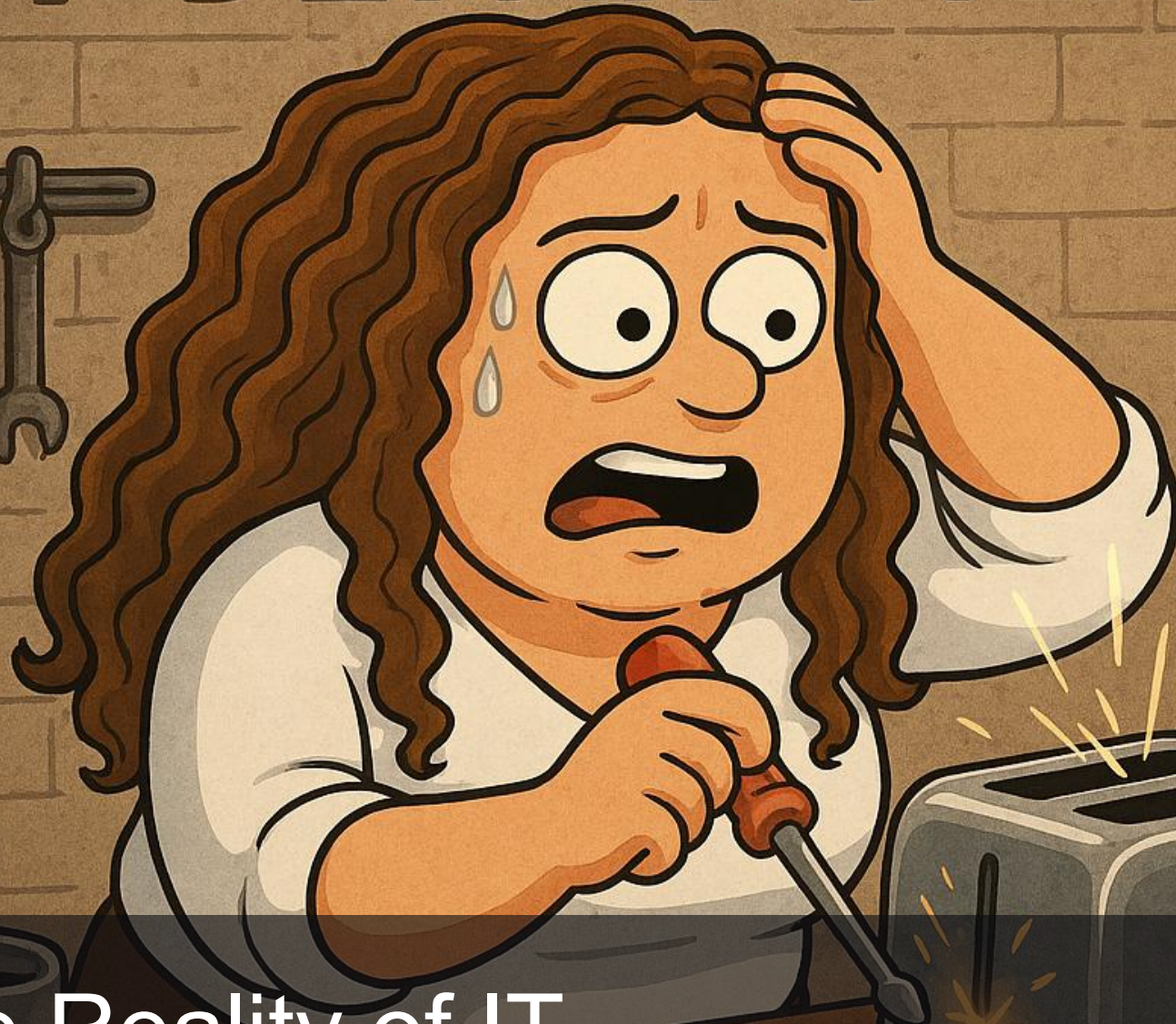
- Discover how Secure Score enhances visibility into your security posture and aids in risk-based decision-making.
- Recognize the overlap between Intune and Security admins, emphasizing the importance of collaboration over competition.
- Utilize existing resources effectively, avoiding the need for numerous additional agents.
- Gain practical strategies to transform Secure Score insights into meaningful actions that align with organizational goals.

Why are we here?

- My Boss told me to attend this session..
- Something about 200k devices being wiped..
- I got “voluntold” I was now the security admin
- My organization bought E5 licenses and stated we were “secure”

Fun fact is that many of us are “thrown” into a situation of having to concern ourselves about the security of our org

IT DEPARTMENT

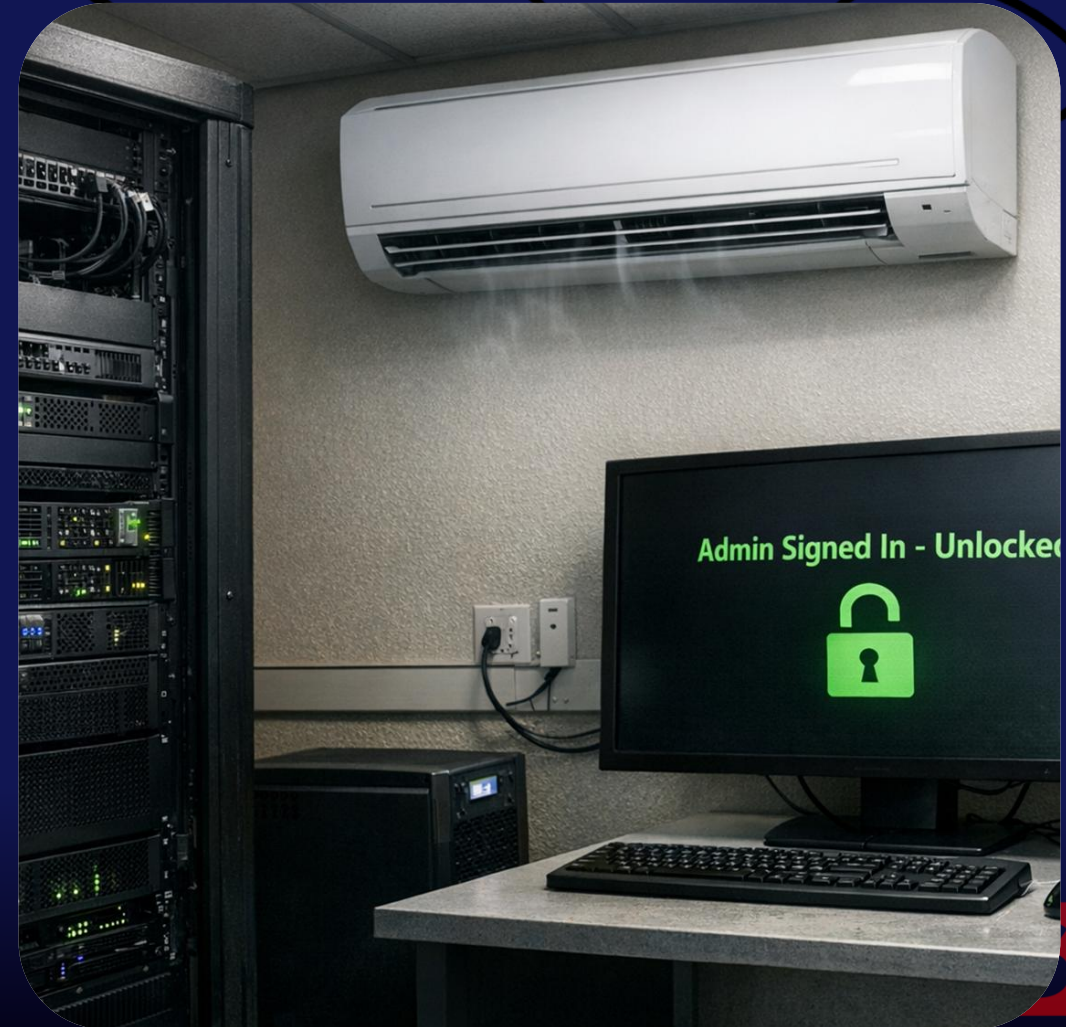


The Reality of IT..

Security as a Service

Wasn't security always "ON" by default?

- ◆ Remember when you had a physical piece of kit called a "server"?
- It's home might have been under the stairs, or in the corner of a room
- Fancy server owners had "air conditioning."
- ◆ But apart from where it was stored, was it secure?
- Is Windows Server OS hardened from the base installation?
- Are identities secure with the base identity requirements of a "password"



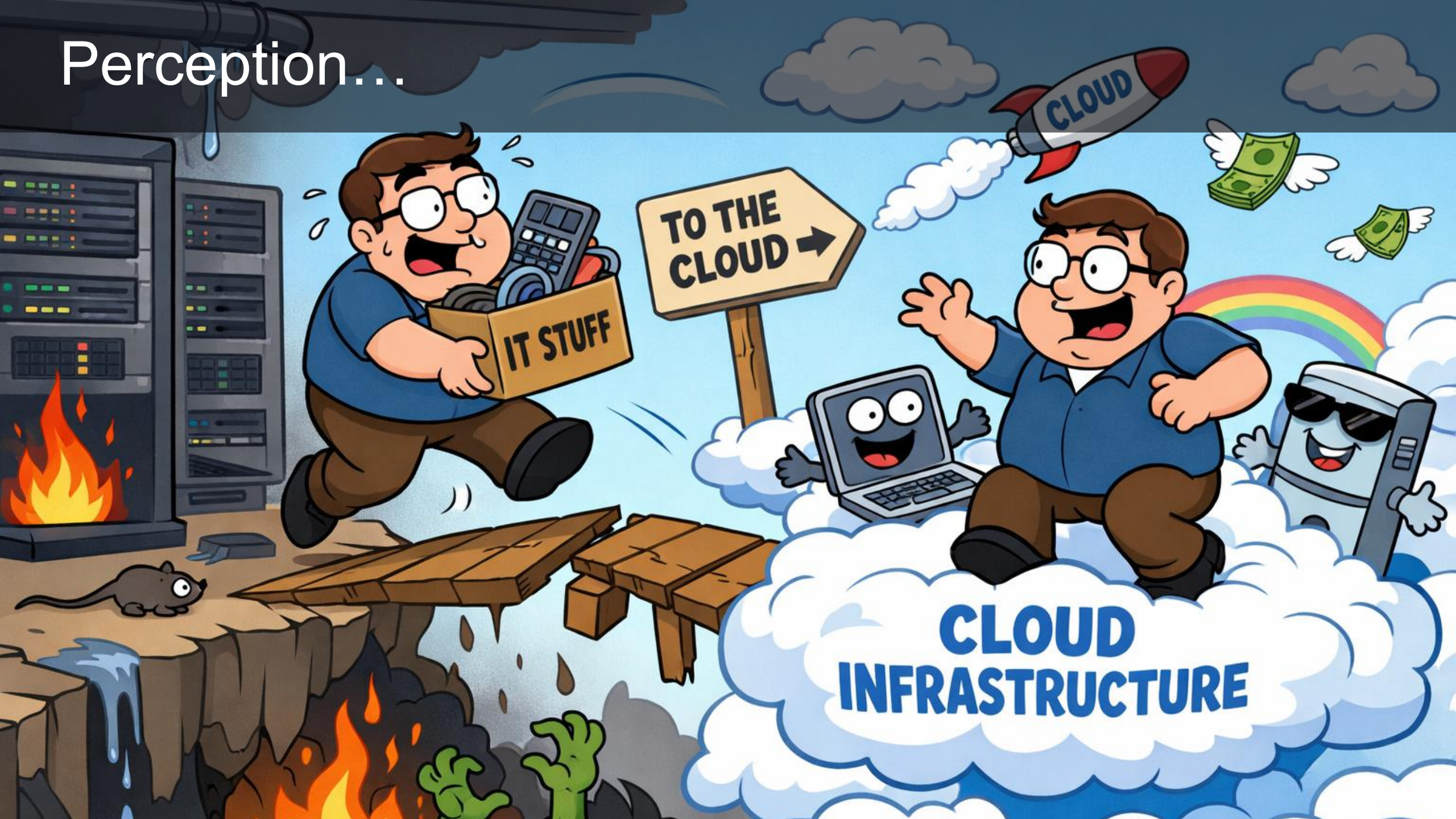
Security as a Service

How is this any different??

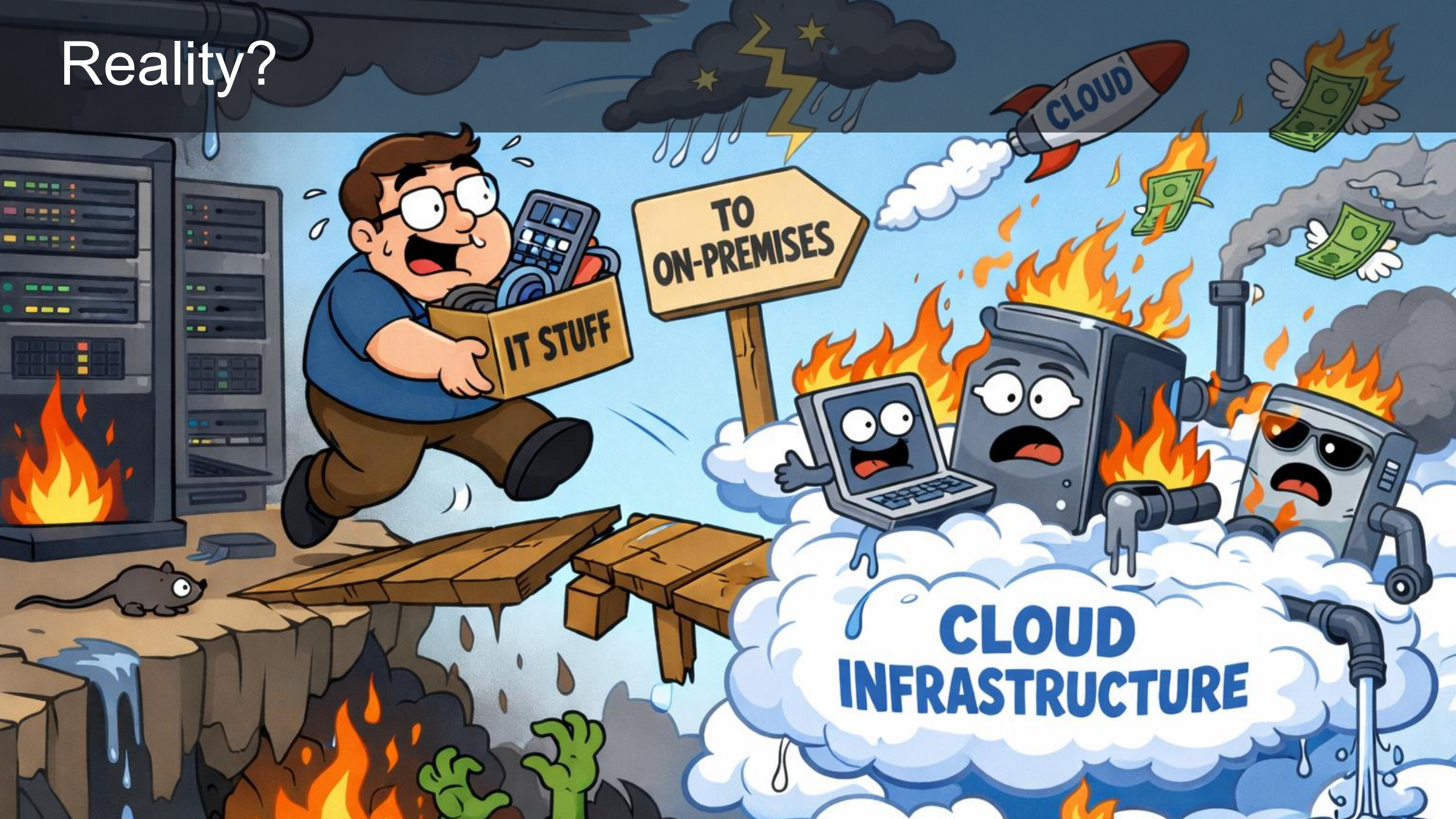
- ◆ I have a Microsoft license, and my “server” is now somewhere in the cloud, I am secure.. right?
- ◆ NO
The same requirements still exist.
This is up to YOU to secure your environment



Perception...



Reality?



Cloud Safe, Cloud Good.. Guess the statistics?

100 Trillion

Security signals processed each day

5 Billion

Emails screened daily on average – Defender for Office

38 Million

Identity risk detections analysed on an average day

15000+

Partners in the Microsoft Security Ecosystem

34000

Full time security engineers employed

4.5 Million

Net new malware files blocked every day



Microsoft Digital Defense Report

Countries where customers are most frequently impacted by cyber threats (January-June 2025)

Scale of impact

Most impacted



Least impacted

		% of total
1	United States	24.8%
2	United Kingdom	5.6%
3	Israel	3.5%
4	Germany	3.3%
5	Ukraine	2.8%
6	Canada	2.6%
7	Japan	2.6%
8	India	2.3%
9	United Arab Emirates	2.0%
10	Australia / Taiwan	1.8%

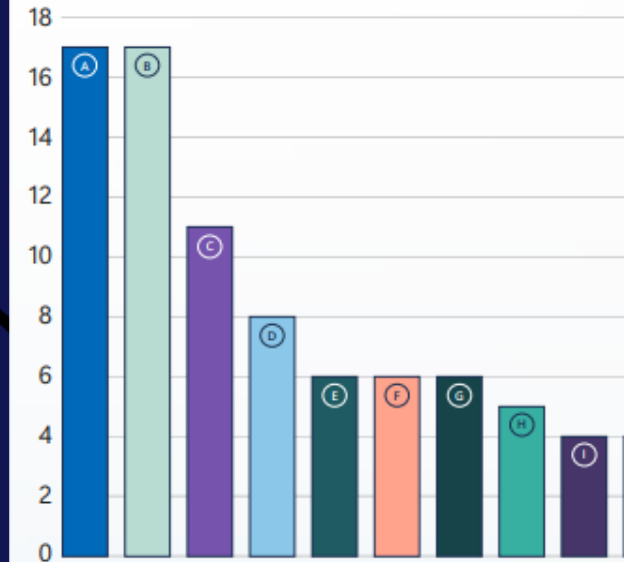


Source: Microsoft Threat Intelligence

Source: Microsoft Threat Intelligence

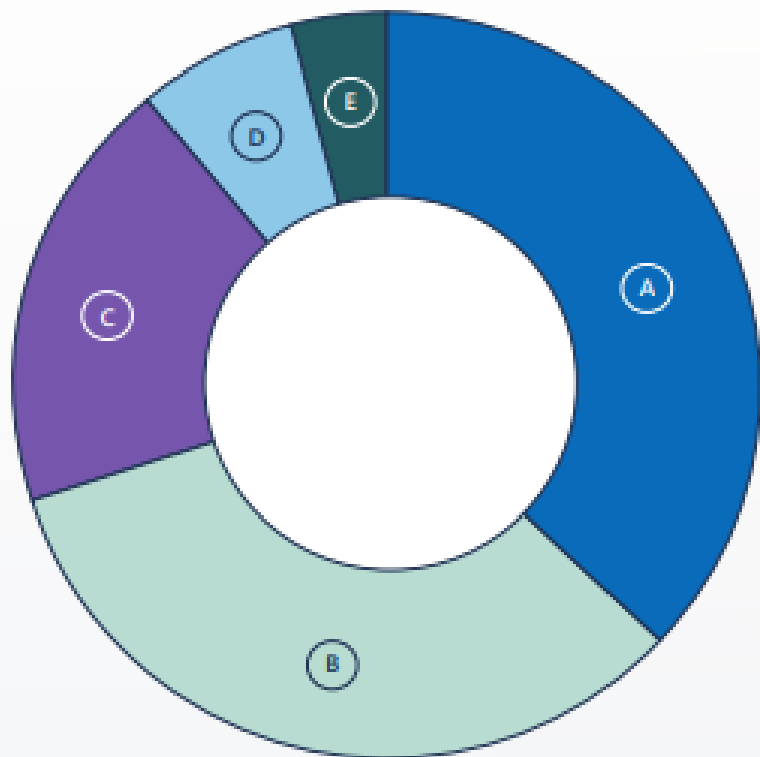
<https://cdn-dynmedia-1.microsoft.com/is/content/microsoftcorp/microsoft/msc/documents/presentations/CSR/Microsoft-Digital-Defense-Report-2025.pdf>

Ten global sectors most impacted by threat actors (January-June 2025)



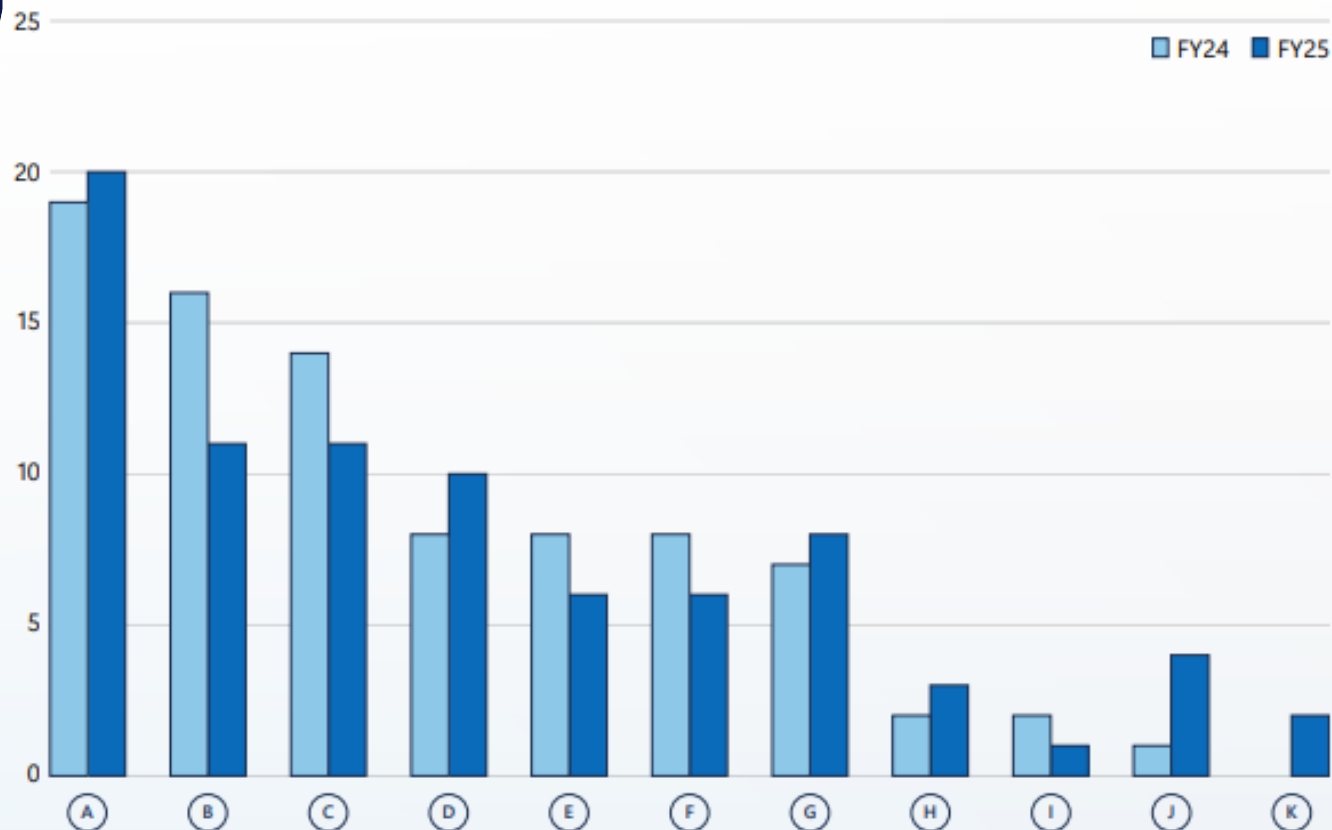
- A. Government agencies & services
- B. Information technology
- C. Research and academia
- D. Non-governmental organizations
- E. Critical manufacturing
- F. Transportation systems
- G. Consumer retail
- H. Communications infrastructure
- I. Financial services
- J. Healthcare and public health

Identified motivations in incident response engagements



	%
A. Data theft	37
B. Extortion	33
C. Destruction/human-operated ransomware	19
D. Infrastructure building	7
E. Espionage	4

Comparing initial access vectors across two years



	FY24	FY25
A. None identified	19%	20%
B. Exploit public-facing application	16%	11%
C. Valid accounts	14%	11%
D. Social engineering	8%	10%
E. External remote services	8%	6%
F. Phishing	8%	6%
G. Other	7%	8%
H. Content injection	2%	3%
I. Trusted relationship	2%	1%
J. Drive-by compromise	1%	4%
K. Supply chain compromise	—	2%

Documents/press: Microsoft Incident Response, Detection and Response Team

“Security is hard”.. So many things to focus on..

Conditional Access

The framework of who/what/where for access to your Entra tenant and associated resources

Identity Protection

What happens when user identities go bad

Privileged Identity Management

When an admin, isn't really an admin, until something happens

Monitoring Sign-Ins

There is no point in having something that is logged, if you are not monitoring it

Microsoft Secure Score

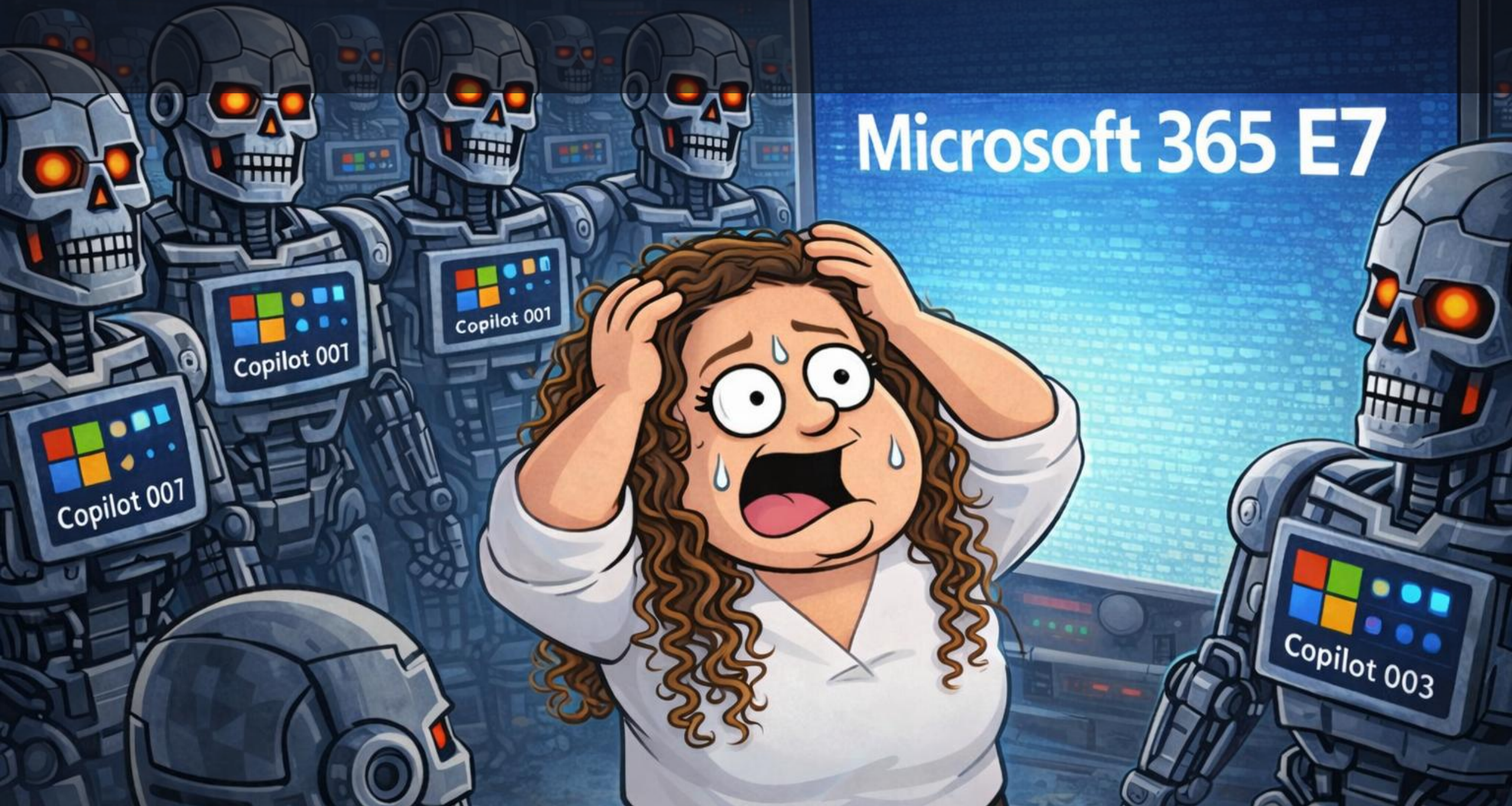
Microsoft lending a helping hand and pointing out some areas of improvement





This is fine.

Microsoft 365 E7



What is Microsoft Secure Score?

The truth: Secure Score measures configuration adoption –
A high score DOES NOT equal low business risk





🔍 Find by title

Protect your cloud apps

Protect your IoT/OT assets

> Protect your AI assets

▼ Microsoft Secure Score

Overview

What's new

Assess your security posture

Track your score history and meet goals

Data storage and privacy

> Investigate and respond to threats

> Identity Security

> Enhance security operations

> Manage multitenant environments

> Manage roles and permissions

> Reference

> Resources

Microsoft Secure Score



Summarize this article for me

Microsoft Secure Score is a measurement of an organization's security posture, with a higher number indicating more recommended actions taken. It can be found at [Microsoft Secure Score](#) in the Microsoft Defender portal.

Following the Secure Score recommendations can protect your organization from threats. From a centralized dashboard in the Microsoft Defender portal, organizations can monitor and work on the security of their Microsoft 365 identities, apps, and devices.

Secure Score helps organizations:

- Report on the current state of the organization's security posture.
- Improve their security posture by providing discoverability, visibility, guidance, and control.
- Compare with benchmarks and establish key performance indicators (KPIs).

In this article

How it works

Secure Score permissions

Risk awareness

We want to hear from you

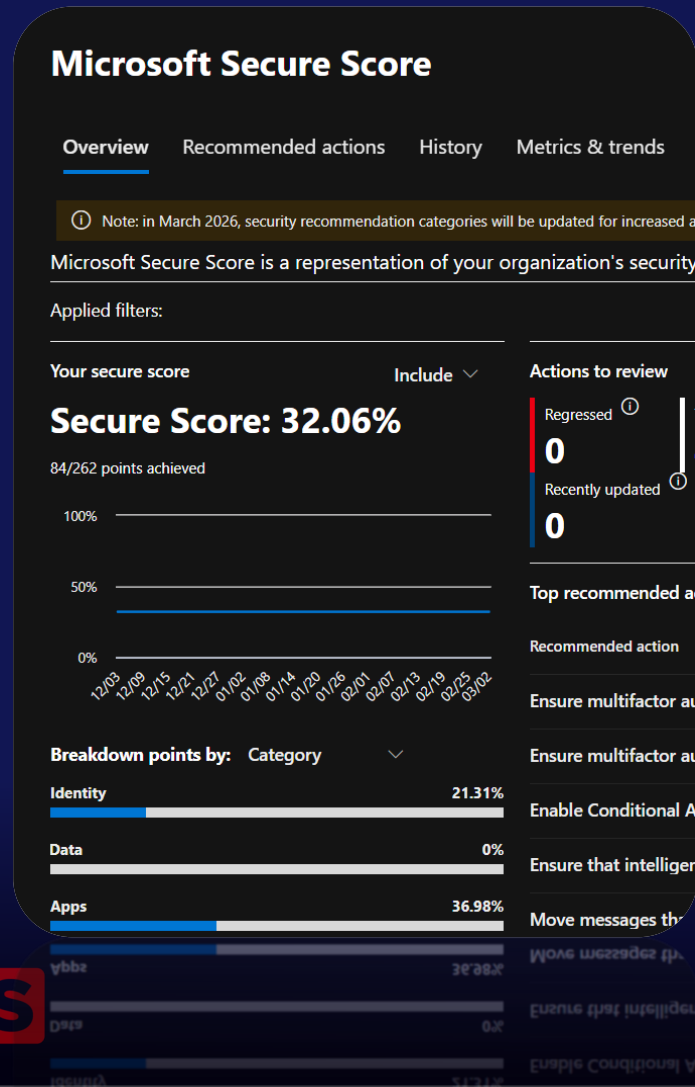
Related resources

Was this page helpful?

👍 Yes

👎 No

Out of the box “security”



The average new tenant secure score is around 33%..

So that is only a 1/3 as good as things could be, and some of the defaults are indeed.. Scary..

Out of the box “security”

Microsoft Secure Score

Overview Recommended actions History Metrics & trends

i Note: in March 2026, security recommendation categories will be updated for increased a

Microsoft Secure Score is a representation of your organization's security

Applied filters:

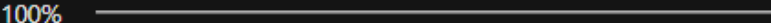
Your secure score

Include 

Secure Score: 92.52%

1289.79/1394 points achieved

100%



90%



Actions to review

Regressed *i*

0

Recently updated *i*

0

Top recommended ac

The average new tenant secure score is around 33%..

So that is only a 1/3 as good as things could be, and some of the defaults are indeed.. Scary..

The Four Pillars of Secure Score

◆ Identity

Protecting the identity of your users from identity things like re-use, poor MFA methods etc

◆ Data*

Protecting your files from going places without you

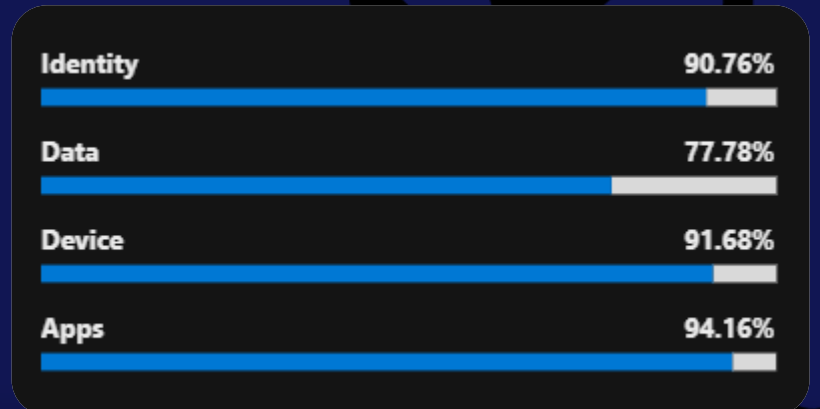
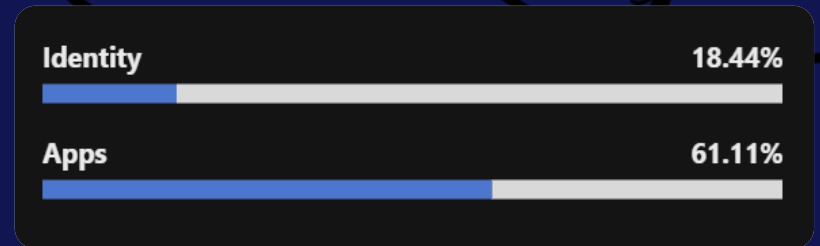
◆ Device*

Securing your devices, both personal & corporate

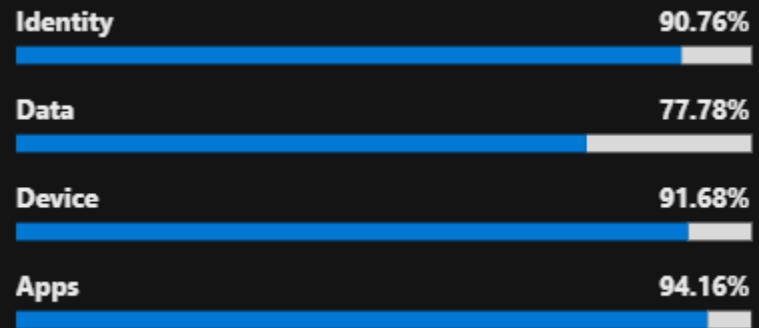
◆ Apps

Patching your way to protection

* Needs onboarded devices for data



The Four Pillars of Secure Score



- ◆ Onboarding
 - ◆ Enable Intune Connection
 - ◆ Enable the OS platform
 - ◆ Deploy a Endpoint Detection & Response policy to clients

Microsoft Intune connection

On

Connects to [Microsoft Intune](#) to enable sharing of device information and enhanced policy enforcement.

Intune provides additional information about managed devices for secure score. It can use risk information to enforce [conditional access](#) and other security policies.

Connectors and tokens | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Search Refresh Save Discard Delete

Windows

- Windows enterprise certificate
- Microsoft Endpoint Configuration Manager
- Windows 365 partner connectors
- Windows data

Apple

- Apple VPP Tokens

Android and ChromeOS

- Managed Google Play
- Chrome Enterprise
- Firmware over-the-air update

Cross platform

- Microsoft Defender for Endpoint
- Mobile Threat Defense
- Partner device management
- Partner compliance management
- TeamViewer connector
- ServiceNow connector
- Certificate connectors
- Derived Credentials

Endpoint Security Policy

Allow Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Compliance policy

Connect Android devices

Connect iOS/iPadOS devices

Connect Windows devices

Enable App Sync (send full application)

Enable Certificate Sync (send full certificate)

Block unsupported connectors

Configuration settings Review

Search

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Microsoft Defender for Endpoint client configuration package type

Onboarding blob from Connector *

Sample Sharing

[Deprecated] Telemetry Reporting Frequency

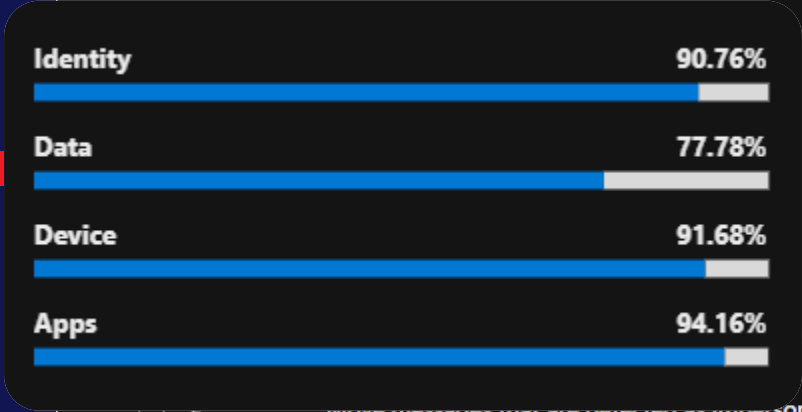
Auto from connector

.....

All (Default)

Not configured

Microsoft Secure Score



...s & trends

...updates may take up to 24 hours.

130 items

		Score imp...	Points achi...	Status	Regress...	Have license	Cat...	Product	Last synced
	Protection is enabled	+1.36%	0/8	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Defender for Office	4/7/2026
	move messages that are detected as impersonated users by mailbox intelligenc	+1.36%	0/8	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Defender for Office	4/7/2026
☐ 3	Enable impersonated domain protection	+1.36%	0/8	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Defender for Office	4/7/2026
☐ 4	Enable impersonated user protection	+1.36%	0/8	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Defender for Office	4/7/2026
☐ 5	Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection sign-in risk policies	+1.19%	0/7	To address	No	Yes	Identity	Microsoft Entra ID	4/6/2026
☐ 6	Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection user risk policies	+1.19%	0/7	To address	No	Yes	Identity	Microsoft Entra ID	4/6/2026
☐ 7	Ensure 'Phishing-resistant MFA strength' is required for Administrators	+1.19%	0/7	To address	No	Yes	Identity	Microsoft Entra ID	4/7/2026
☐ 8	Quarantine messages that are detected from impersonated domains	+1.02%	0/6	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Defender for Office	4/7/2026
☐ 9	Quarantine messages that are detected from impersonated users	+1.02%	0/6	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Defender for Office	4/7/2026
☐ 10	Ensure that password hash sync is enabled for hybrid deployments	+0.85%	0/5	To address	Yes	Yes	Identity	Microsoft Entra ID	4/6/2026
☐ 11	Ensure 'External sharing' of calendars is not available	+0.85%	0/5	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Exchange Online	4/7/2026
☐ 12	Ensure additional storage providers are restricted in Outlook on the web	+0.85%	0/5	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Exchange Online	4/7/2026
☐ 13	Set action to take on high confidence spam detection	+0.85%	0/5	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Exchange Online	4/7/2026
☐ 14	Set action to take on phishing detection	+0.85%	0/5	To address	No	Yes	Apps	Exchange Online	4/7/2026

Please Note: Data can take up to 72 hours post onboarding

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Identity

(Protecting the identity of your users from identity things like re-use, poor MFA methods etc)

◆ Conditional Access

◆ Zero Trust Model

- ◆ NO IP ranges or trusted locations, except for specific scenarios
- ◆ Default = Allow all.. Oh dear
- ◆ Persona's.. Like groups of people, but better(ish)

Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users in administrative roles

Alternate mitigation

Edit status & action plan Manage tags

General Implementation

Action plan

This account is using a 30+ character password and is stored in a physical vault as a break the glass account. Additionally we will configure the account to be monitored for risky sign ins.

Description

Requiring multifactor authentication (MFA) for administrative roles makes it harder for attackers to access accounts. Administrative roles have higher permissions than typical users. If any of those accounts are compromised, your entire organization is exposed. At a minimum, protect the following roles:

- Global administrator
- Authentication administrator
- Billing administrator
- Conditional Access administrator
- Exchange administrator
- Helpdesk administrator
- Security administrator
- SharePoint administrator
- User administrator

Implementation status

You have marked this action as resolved through alternate mitigation.

User impact

First, users with administrative roles need to register for MFA. After each admin is registered, your policies then determine when they're prompted for the additional authentication factors.

Users affected

All of your Microsoft 365 users with administrator roles

Details

Points achieved

10 / 10

History

0 events

Category

Identity

Product

Microsoft Entra ID

Protects against

[Password Cracking](#), [Account Breach](#), [Elevation of Privilege](#)

Identity

(Protecting the identity of your users from identity things like re-use, poor MFA methods etc)

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Details

Points achieved

10 / 10

History

0 events

Category

Identity

Product

Microsoft Entra ID

Protects against

Password Cracking, Account Breach, Elevation of Privilege

Status & action plan

Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users in administrative roles

Update the status and action plan for this recommended action. System-generated statuses can't be updated.

Status

- ☐ Completed
- ☐ To address
- ☐ Planned
- ☐ Risk accepted
- ☐ Resolved through third party
- ☒ Resolved through alternate mitigation

Action plan

This account is using a 30+ character password and is stored in a physical vault as a break the glass account. Additionally we will configure the account to be monitored for risky sign ins.

CA001 - Global - BaseProtection -

AllApps - AnyPlatform -

NonPersonas - Block



Identity

(Protecting the identity of your users from identity things like re-use, poor MFA methods etc)

♦ Risk Policies

- ♦ Sometimes policy types are not well defined as to the way in which the score is obtained from

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Entra ID console interface for configuring a Conditional Access policy. The policy name is 'CA205 - Internals - AllApps - High User Risk - MFA & Change Pwd - Grant'. The 'General' tab is selected, showing the policy's purpose: 'Control access based on Conditional Access policy to bring signals together, to make decisions, and enforce organizational policies.' The 'Action plan' section is highlighted with a yellow box, showing the implementation through the 'Description' tab. The 'Description' tab shows the policy is turned on for sign-in multifactor authentication. The 'Assignments' section shows the policy is assigned to 'All resources (formerly 'All cloud apps')'. The 'Network' section shows 'Not available'. The 'Conditions' section shows '1 condition selected'. The 'Access controls' section shows '1 control selected'.

Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection sign-in risk policies

Alternate mitigation CA205 - Internals - AllApps - High User Risk - MFA & Change Pwd - Grant

Conditional Access policy

Edit status & actions Delete View policy information View policy impact

Control access based on Conditional Access policy to bring signals together, to make decisions, and enforce organizational policies. [Learn more](#)

General Imp

Action plan

Implementing through

Description

Turning on the sign-in multifactor authentication

Assignments

Users or agents (Preview)

Specific users included and specific users excluded

Target resources

All resources (formerly 'All cloud apps')

Network NEW

Not available

Conditions

1 condition selected

Access controls

Grant *

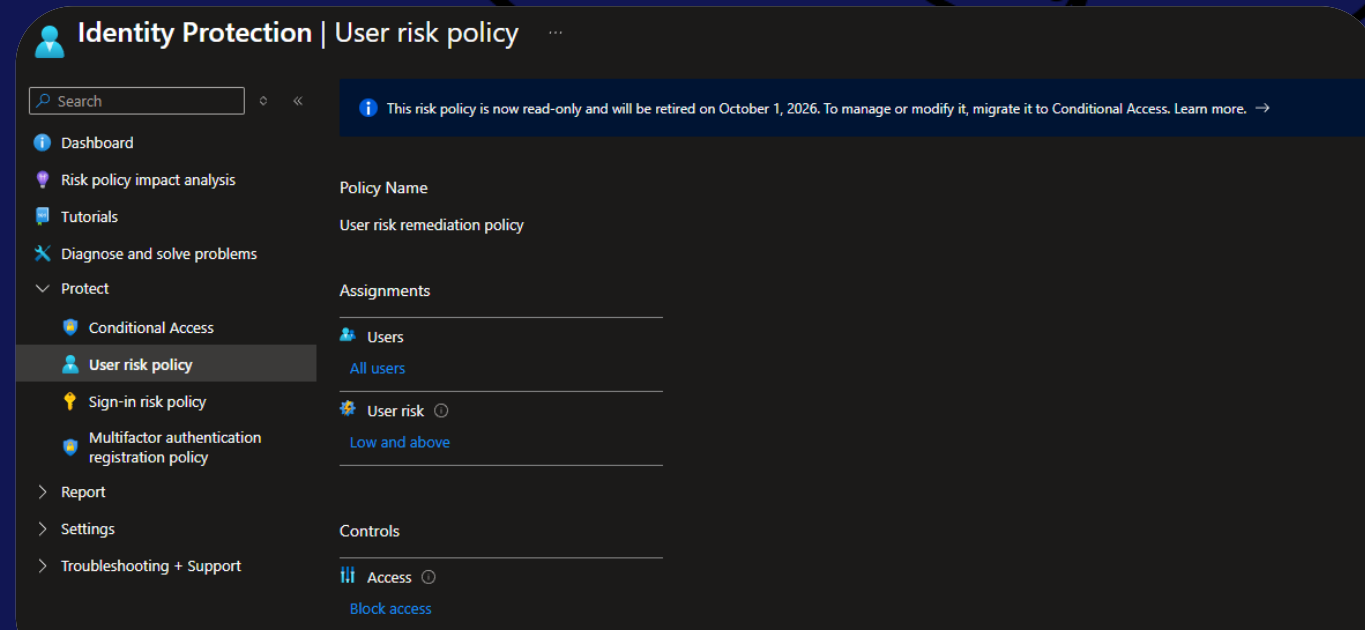
1 control selected

Identity

(Protecting the identity of your users from identity things like re-use, poor MFA methods etc)

◆ Risk Policies

- ◆ Sometimes policy types are not well defined as to the way in which the score is obtained from



i This risk policy is now read-only and will be retired on October 1, 2026. To manage or modify it, migrate it to Conditional Access. Learn more. →

Identity

(Protecting the identity of your users from identity things like re-use, poor MFA methods etc)

◆ Risk Policies

- ◆ Sometimes policy types are not well defined as to the way in which the score is obtained from

Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection sign-in risk policies

○ Planned

[Edit status & action plan](#) [Manage tags](#)

General Implementation History (3)

Prerequisites

✗ Microsoft Entra ID Premium P2 is needed.

Next steps

1. To implement this re under "Prerequisite:
2. If you've invested in template. [Follow th](#)
3. If you're not using

[Learn more](#)
None

General Implementation

Prerequisites

You have marked this action as resolved through alternate mitigation.

Next steps

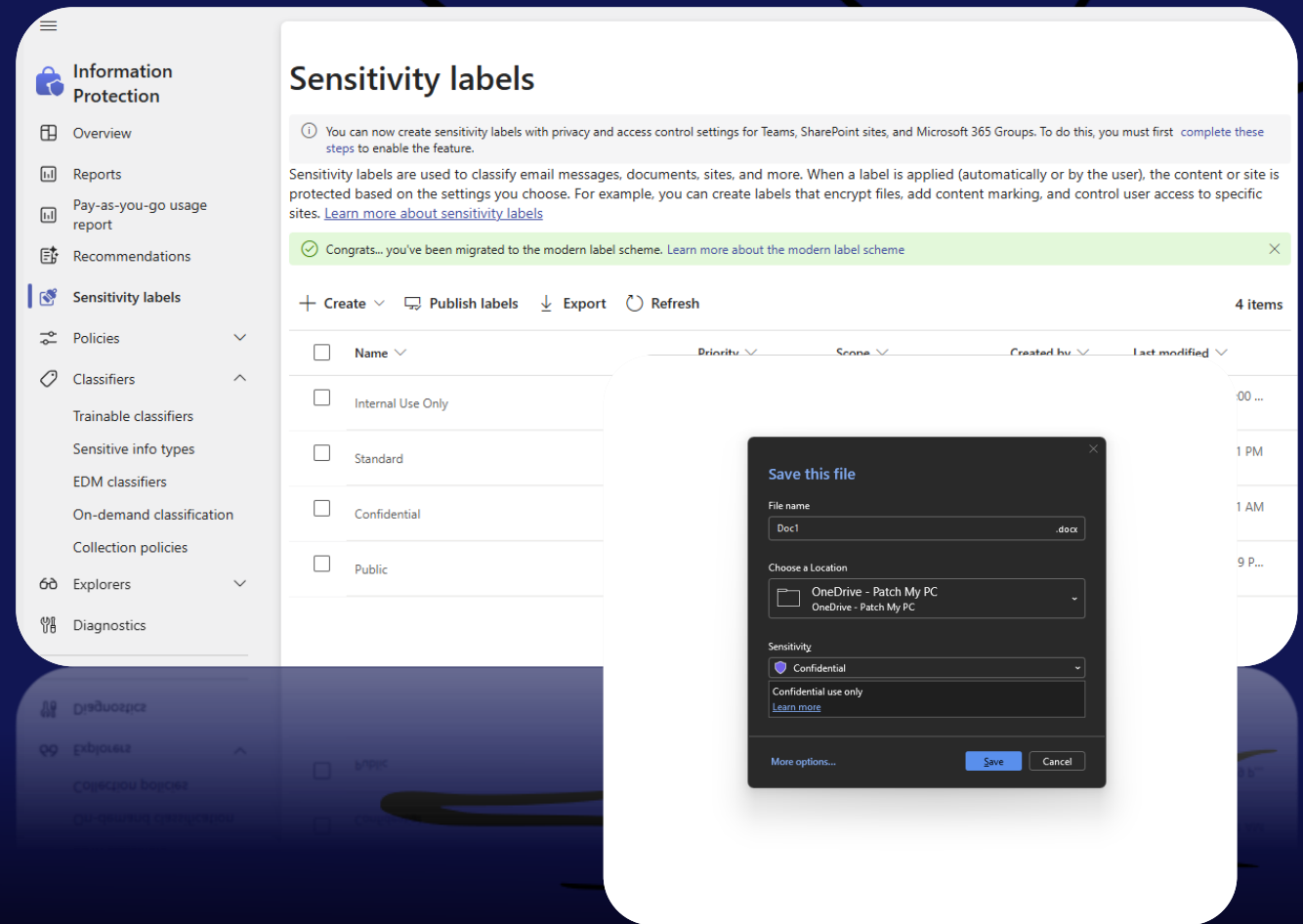
You have marked this action as resolved through alternate mitigation.

[Learn more](#)
None

Data

◆ Sensitivity Labels

- ◆ A minimum requirement in Secure Score to improve your data score
- ◆ Simple to roll out
- ◆ Can be integrated with Defender for Cloud Apps & Exchange Online to help ensure confidential data remains just that



Device (This probably makes sense the most)

- ◆ The Device category contains the highest number of items to address typically.
- ◆ Some will make complete sense to you..
- ◆ Others will have you questioning your life choices..

The screenshot displays the Microsoft Secure Score interface. The top navigation bar includes 'Overview', 'Recommended actions', 'History', and 'Metrics & trends'. Below this, a message states: 'Actions you can take to improve your Microsoft Secure Score. Score updates may take up to 24 hours.' A table lists 235 items, with columns for Rank, Recommended action, Score L, Points a, Status, Regress..., Have license?, Cat..., and Product. The table shows several items related to Microsoft Defender Firewall, Antivirus, and macOS Firewall, all with a status of 'Completed'. A modal window is open, showing details for the recommendation 'Set 'Enforce password history' to '24 or more password(s)' in macOS'. The modal includes a description, potential risk, recommendation insights, and details such as tags, category, configuration ID, exposed devices, and impact.

Microsoft Secure Score

Overview Recommended actions History Metrics & trends

Actions you can take to improve your Microsoft Secure Score. Score updates may take up to 24 hours.

Export 235 items Search Filter Group by

Rank	Recommended action	Score L	Points a	Status	Regress...	Have license?	Cat...	Product
105	Turn on Microsoft Defender Firewall	+0.72%	10/10	Completed	No	Yes	Device	Defender for Endpoint
106	Turn on Microsoft Defender Antivirus	+0.72%	10/10	Completed	No	Yes	Device	Defender for Endpoint
107	Enable Microsoft Defender Antivirus scanning of downloaded f	+0.72%	10/10	Completed	No	Yes	Device	Defender for Endpoint
108	Turn on Firewall in macOS	+0.72%	10/10	Completed	No	Yes	Device	Defender for Endpoint
109	Turn on Microsoft Defender Antivirus real-time protection in m	+0.72%	10/10	Completed	No	Yes	Device	Defender for Endpoint
110	Update Microsoft Defender for Endpoint core components	+0.72%	10/10	Completed	No	Yes	Device	Defender for Endpoint
111	Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users in adn	+0.72%	10/10	Alternate mitgNo	Yes	Identity	Microsoft Entra ID	
74	Turn on real-time protection	+0.72%	9.94/10	To address	No	Yes	Device	Defender for Endpoint
31	Turn on Microsoft Defe							
32	Fix Microsoft Defende							
112	Ensure multifactor au							

Set 'Enforce password history' to '24 or more password(s)' in macOS

Under exception (Alternate mitigation)

Open software page Report inaccuracy

General Remediation options Exposed devices

This recommendation is currently under Exception status. To request remediation, the existing exception must first be cancelled. [View related exception](#)

Description
Determines the number of unique new passwords that are required before an old password can be reused in association with a user account.

Potential risk
Password reuse is an important concern in any organization. Many users want to reuse the same password for their account over a long period of time.

Recommendation insights

- No devices in your organization are configured as recommended
- This configuration is recommended by the following benchmarks: STIG

[Get more insights into how well your organization is protected against ransomware in exposure management.](#)

Details

Tags

Category
Accounts

Configuration ID
scid:5004

Exposed devices
28 / 28

Devices pending restart
0 / 28

Impact
0.00 | 5.00

Set 'Enforce password history' to '24 or more password(s)' in macOS

○ Under exception (Alternate mitigation)

➔ Open software page  Report inaccuracy

General

Remediation options

Exposed devices

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Details

Tags

-

Category

Accounts

Configuration ID

scid-5004

Exposed devices

28 / 28

Devices pending restart

0 / 28

Impact

▼ 0.00 | + 5.00

▲ 0'00 | + 2'00

Impact

CVE's Everywhere..



Apps (TVM)

- ◆ Patching is hard..
 - ◆ Autopatch takes care of the Microsoft bits, but what about apps, like I don't know.. NotePad++?
 - ◆ CVE's are present everywhere, and updates are more frequent than Microsoft's usual monthly cadence
 - ◆ Software vendors don't make it easy in some cases.. Install Cxxxxxa 2026 and keep Cxxxxxa 2025

The screenshot displays the 'Inventories' application interface. The top section shows a list of software components with columns for Name, OS platform, Vendor, Weaknesses, Threats, Exposed devices, Impact, and Tags. Below this, a detailed view for 'Nodejs' is shown, including a 'Version distribution' tab. This view lists specific versions of Node.js (25.8.2.0, 25.8.1.0, 25.9.0.0, 24.14.0.0, 25.2.1.0) along with their detected counts, discovered vulnerabilities, and the number of devices using each version.

Version	Detected on	Discovered vulnerabilities	Devices using this version
25.8.2.0	21	0	10
25.8.1.0	3	8	2
25.9.0.0	2	0	0
24.14.0.0	1	7	0
25.2.1.0	1	8	0

Apps

Inventories

Software

Software components

Browser extensions

Certificates

Hardware & Firmware

Devices

Cloud

Software

1,177

Export

1177 items

Search

Filter

Customize columns

Filter by device groups (4/4)

Name	OS platform	Vendor	Weaknesses	Threats	Exposed devices	Impact	Tags
☐ Edge Webview2 Runtime	Windows	Microsoft	1.23k		131 / 143	44.30	
☐ Edge Chromium-based	Windows	Microsoft	201				
☐ Chrome	Windows	Google	525				
☐ Teams	Windows	Microsoft	5				
☐ Windows 11	Windows	Microsoft	527				
☐ Chrome for Mac	macOS	Google	271				
☐ Edge Chromium-based for Mac	macOS	Microsoft	79				
☐ Python	Windows	Python	50				
☐ Remote Desktop Manager for Mac	macOS	Devolutions	7				
☐ Mac Os	macOS	Apple	197				
☐ Keynote for Mac	macOS	Apple	1				
☐ Pages for Mac	macOS	Apple	1				
☐ Visual Studio Code	Windows	Microsoft	2				

N

Nodejs

Overview

Security recommendations (1)

Discovered vulnerabilities

Devices with components (28)

Version distribution (5)

Event timeline (2)

Maximize

The list below only includes versions of the software with a valid product code.

Export

5 items

Search

Filter

Customize columns

Filter by device groups (4/4)

Version	Detected on	Discovered vulnerabilities	Devices using this version (3...)	Tags
☐ 25.8.2.0	21	0	10	
☐ 25.8.1.0	3	8	2	
☐ 25.9.0.0	2	0	0	
☐ 24.14.0.0	1	7	0	
☐ 25.2.1.0	1	8	0	

Apps

- ◆ Configuration is hard
 - ◆ Settings Catalog is great, but what about those settings that simply you can't set, Registry we are looking at you..
- ◆ Creativity required
 - ◆ PowerShell
 - ◆ Storage Tables / CSV's

Disable Flash on Adobe Reader DC

● Remediation required

[Open software page](#) [Report inaccuracy](#)

General Remediation options

Set the following registry value:

HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Adobe\Acrobat Reader\DC\FeatureLockDown\bEnableFlash

To the following REG_DWORD value:

0

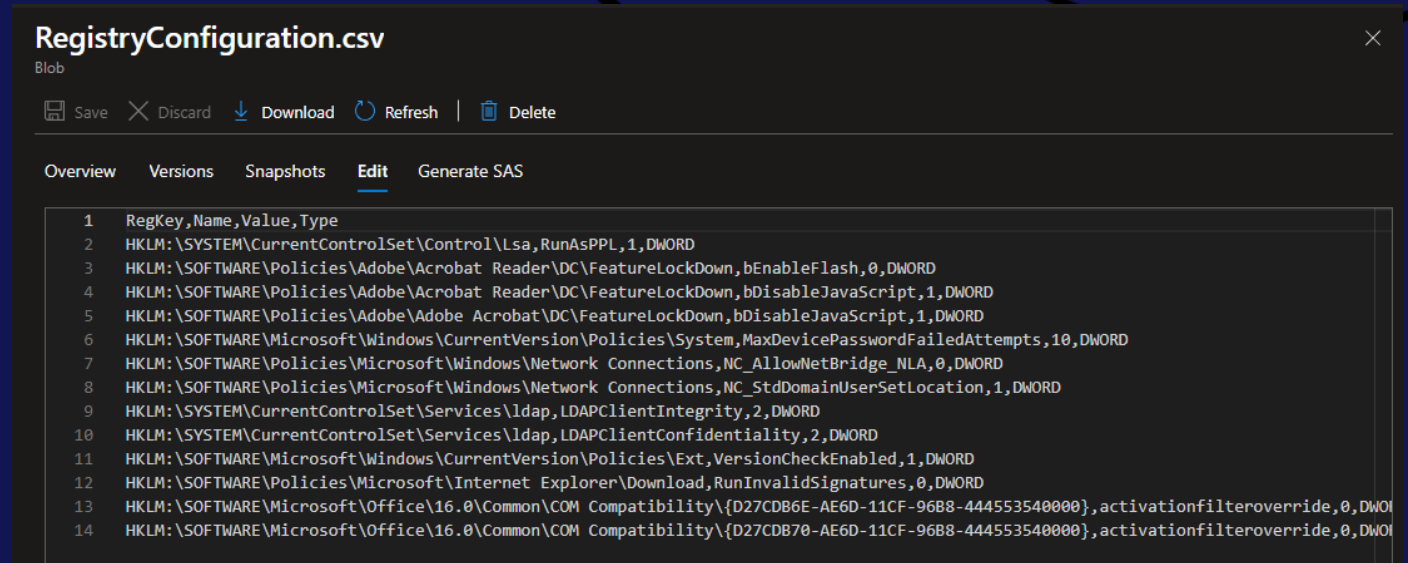
Application (Adobe Acrobat)

☐	168	Disable Flash on Adobe Reader DC	+0.36%	5/5	Completed	No	Yes	Device	Defender for Endpoint	4/2/2
--------------------------	-----	----------------------------------	--------	-----	-----------	----	-----	--------	-----------------------	-------

Work around section

♦ Example: Registry key in Flash (can't do in Intune, need remediation scripts)

- How do we mitigate and report on these settings?
- Remediations are your friend
 - Detection – Check for value x
 - Remediation – Fix value X



```
RegistryConfiguration.csv
Blob
Save Discard Download Refresh Delete
Overview Versions Snapshots Edit Generate SAS
1 RegKey,Name,Value,Type
2 HKLM:\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Control\Lsa,RunAsPPL,1,DWORD
3 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Policies\Adobe\Acrobat Reader\DC\FeatureLockDown,bEnableFlash,0,DWORD
4 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Policies\Adobe\Acrobat Reader\DC\FeatureLockDown,bDisableJavaScript,1,DWORD
5 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Policies\Adobe\Acrobat Reader\DC\FeatureLockDown,bDisableJavaScript,1,DWORD
6 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\System,MaxDevicePasswordFailedAttempts,10,DWORD
7 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\Network Connections,NC_AllowNetBridge_NLA,0,DWORD
8 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\Network Connections,NC_StdDomainUserSetLocation,1,DWORD
9 HKLM:\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\ldap,LDAPClientIntegrity,2,DWORD
10 HKLM:\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\ldap,LDAPClientConfidentiality,2,DWORD
11 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Ext,VersionCheckEnabled,1,DWORD
12 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Internet Explorer\Download,RunInvalidSignatures,0,DWORD
13 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Office\16.0\Common\COM Compatibility\{D27CDB6E-AE6D-11CF-96B8-444553540000},activationfilteroverride,0,DWORD
14 HKLM:\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Office\16.0\Common\COM Compatibility\{D27CDB70-AE6D-11CF-96B8-444553540000},activationfilteroverride,0,DWORD
```

♦ Conflicting recommendations from Microsoft vs CIS vs NIST

A large, stylized black line drawing of a snake, possibly a cobra, with its head raised and tongue flicking. A thick red horizontal band runs across the middle of the snake's body. The background is a solid dark blue. In the bottom left corner, there is a small dark grey rounded rectangle containing the text 'ps (4/4)' in white.

Microsoft Secure Score

Overview Recommended actions History Metrics & trends

Note: in March 2026, security recommendation categories will be updated for increased impacted.

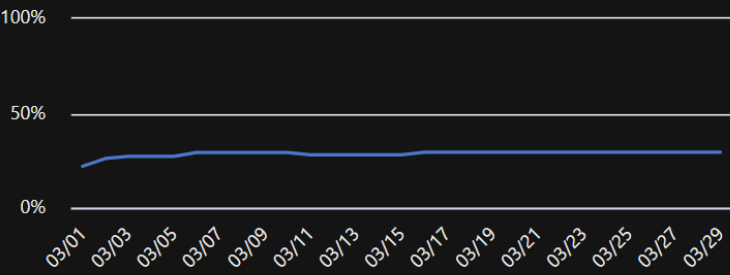
Microsoft Secure Score is a representation of your organization's security posture.

Applied filters:

Your secure score Include

Secure Score: 29.41%

41.18/140 points achieved



Microsoft Secure Score

Your score

Export

22 items

Search

Filter

Group by

Date/Time	Activity	Resulting points	Category	Attributed to
Mar 16, 2026 7:00 PM	0.01 points regressed for Ensure 'Self service password reset enabled' is set to 'All' because mo...	0.25/1	Identity	System
Mar 16, 2026 7:00 PM	0.26 points gained for Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users because fewer ...	0.26/9	Identity	System
Mar 16, 2026 7:00 PM	1.67 points gained for Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users in administrativ...	1.67/10	Identity	System
Mar 11, 2026 7:00 PM	0.74 points regressed for Ensure 'Self service password reset enabled' is set to 'All' because mo...	0.26/1	Identity	System
Mar 11, 2026 7:00 PM	-0.00 points score change because Ensure 'User owned apps and services' is restricted has bec...	0/3	Identity	System
Mar 6, 2026 6:00 PM	-0.00 points score change because Ensure user consent to apps accessing company data on th...	0/4	Identity	System
Mar 6, 2026 6:00 PM	+8.00 points score change because Ensure the 'Password expiration policy' is set to 'Set passw...	8/8	Identity	System
Mar 6, 2026 6:00 PM	+1.00 points score change because Ensure 'Self service password reset enabled' is set to 'All' ha...	1/1	Identity	System
Mar 6, 2026 6:00 PM	+8.00 points score change because Enable Conditional Access policies to block legacy authenti...	8/8	Identity	System
Mar 6, 2026 6:00 PM	-0.00 points score change because Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users ha...	0/9	Identity	System
Mar 6, 2026 6:00 PM	-0.00 points score change because Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users in ...	0/10	Identity	System
Mar 6, 2026 6:00 PM	-0.00 points score change because Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection sign-in risk pol...	0/7	Identity	System
Mar 6, 2026 6:00 PM	-0.00 points score change because Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection user risk polici...	0/7	Identity	System



Microsoft Secure Score

Overview Recommended actions History Metrics & trends

Actions you can take to improve your Microsoft Secure Score. Score updates may take up to 24 hours.

Export

34 items

Search

Filter

Group by

Rank	Recommended action	Score i...	Points achi...	Status	Regress...	Have license?	Cat...	Product	
☐	1	Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users	+6.43%	0.26/9	To address	No	No	Identity	Microsoft Entra
☐	2	Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users in adn	+7.14%	1.67/10	To address	No	No	Identity	Microsoft Entra
☐	3	Ensure 'Phishing-resistant MFA strength' is required for Admini	+5%	0/7	To address	No	No	Identity	Microsoft Entra
☐	4	Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection sign-in risk polici	+5%	0/7	To address	No	Ensure 'Self service password reset' is enabled for all users To address Edit status & action plan Mar General Implementation Hi Description With self-service password reset in Micro help desk to reset passwords. This featu banned passwords, which prevents easil Implementation status		
☐	5	Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection user risk policies	+5%	0/7	To address	No			
☐	6	Ensure password protection is enabled for on-prem Active Dire	+4.29%	0/6	To address	No			
☐	7	Ensure third party integrated applications are not allowed	+3.57%	0/5	To address	No			
☐	8	Ensure Sign-in frequency is enabled and browser sessions are n	+3.57%	0/5	To address	No			
☐	9	Ensure the admin consent workflow is enabled	+3.57%	0/5	To address	No			
☐	10	Ensure custom banned passwords lists are used	+3.57%	0/5	To address	No			
☐	11	Ensure user consent to apps accessing company data on their b	+2.86%	0/4	To address	No			
☐	12	Block OneDrive for Business sync from unmanaged devices	+2.14%	0/3	To address	No			

Ensure 'Self service password reset enabled' is set to 'All'

To address

Edit status & action planManage tags

GeneralImplementationHistory (3)

Description

With self-service password reset in Microsoft Entra ID, users no longer need to engage help desk to reset passwords. This feature works well with Microsoft Entra ID dynamically banned passwords, which prevents easily guessable passwords from being used.

Implementation status

You have 27 of 36 users who don't have self-service password reset enabled.

User impact

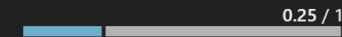
Users will be able to self-service password reset in Microsoft Entra ID and no longer need to engage help desk.

Users affected

All of your Microsoft 365 users

Details

Points achieved



History

3 events

Category

Identity

Product

Microsoft Entra ID

Protects against

Password Cracking, Account Breach



Microsoft Secure Score

Overview Recommended actions History Metrics & trends

Actions you can take to improve your Microsoft Secure Score. Score updates may take up to 24 hours.

Export 1 of 34 selected Search Filter Group by

Rank	Recommended action	Score i...	Points achi...	Status
☐	1 Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users	+6.43%	0.26/9	To address
☐	2 Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users in administrative roles	+7.14%	1.67/10	To address
☐	3 Ensure 'Phishing-resistant MFA strength' is required for Administrators	+5%	0/7	To address
☐	4 Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection sign-in risk policies	+5%	0/7	To address
☒	5 Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection user risk policies			
☐	6 Ensure password protection is enabled for on-prem Active Directory			
☐	7 Ensure third party integrated applications are not allowed			
☐	8 Ensure Sign-in frequency is enabled and browser sessions are not persistent for Administrative users			
☐	9 Ensure the admin consent workflow is enabled			
☐	10 Ensure custom banned passwords lists are used			
☐	11 Ensure user consent to apps accessing company data on their behalf is not allowed			
☐	12 Block OneDrive for Business sync from unmanaged devices			

Conditional Access Policies

Microsoft Entra ID

Overview

Policies

Deleted Policies

Insights and reporting

Diagnose and solve problems

Manage

Named locations

Custom controls (Preview)

Terms of use

VPN connectivity

Authentication contexts

Authentication strengths

Classic policies

Monitoring

Sign-in logs

Audit logs

Troubleshooting + Support

New support request

New policy New policy from template Upload policy file What if Refresh Preview features Got feedback?

Microsoft Entra Conditional Access policies are used to apply access controls to keep your organization secure. Learn more

Microsoft-managed policies

Policies created 0

User created policies

Policies created 4

Search Add filter

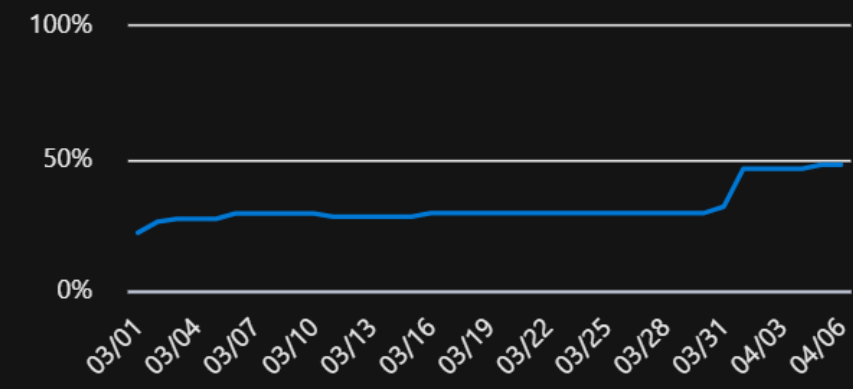
4 out of 4 policies found

Policy name	Created by	State	Alert
MFA for All Users	USER	On	
Multifactor authentication for Microsoft partners and vendors	USER	On	
Sign in Risk Policy	USER	On	
User Risk Policy	USER	On	



Secure Score: 47.66%

434.63/912 points achieved



Breakdown points by: Category

Identity 34.52%

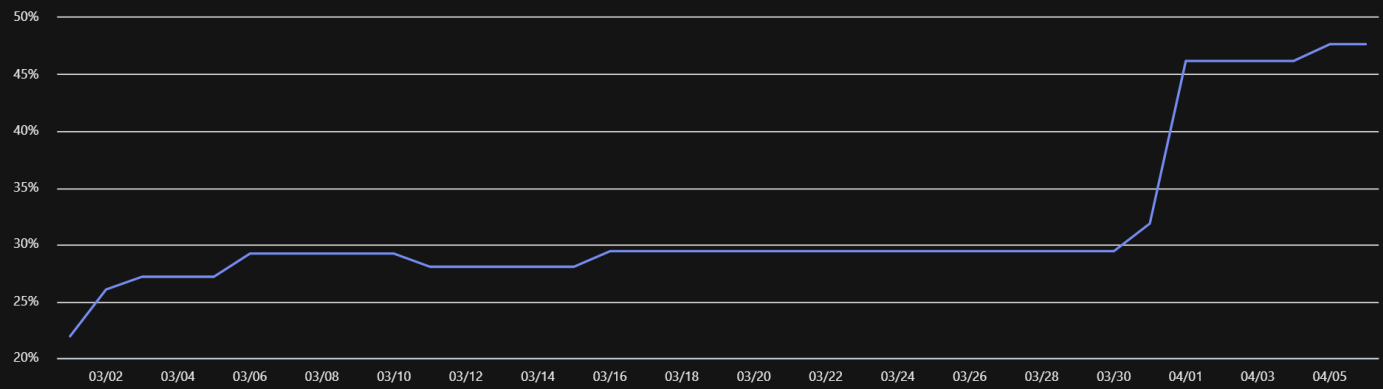
Device 48.89%

Apps 61.11%

Points achieved Opportunity

Microsoft Secure Score

25.74%



Export 138 items Search Filter Group by

Date/Time	Activity	Resulting points	Category	Attributed to
Apr 5, 2026 7:00 PM	0.01 points regressed for Ensure 'Self service password reset enabled' is set to 'All' because mo...	0.24/1	Identity	System
Apr 5, 2026 7:00 PM	0.24 points gained for Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users because fewer ...	0.5/9	Identity	System
Apr 5, 2026 7:00 PM	6.61 points gained for Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection sign-in risk policies becaus...	6.61/7	Identity	System
Apr 5, 2026 7:00 PM	6.61 points gained for Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection user risk policies because f...	6.61/7	Identity	System



DEMO

Enable Microsoft Entra ID Identity Protection user risk policies

 Planned

 Edit status & action plan  Manage tags

General Implementation History (3)

Description

With the user risk policy turned on, Microsoft Entra ID detects the probability that a user account has been compromised. As an administrator, you can configure a user risk Conditional Access policy to automatically respond to a specific user risk level. For example, you can block access to your resources or require a password change to get a user account back into a clean state.

Implementation status

You have 2 users out of 36 that do not have user risk policy enabled.

User impact

When the policy triggers, access to the account will either be blocked or the user would be required to use multifactor authentication and change their password. Users who haven't registered MFA on their account will be blocked from accessing it. If account access is blocked, an admin would need to recover the account. Thus, it is important to configure the MFA registration policy for all users who are a part of the user risk policy to ensure that they have registered MFA.

Users affected

All of your Microsoft 365 users

Details

Points achieved

6.61 / 7

History

[3 events](#)

Category

Identity

Product

Microsoft Entra ID

Protects against

[Password Cracking](#), [Account Breach](#)



DEMO

Secure Score in Action

From tenant zero to security hero.. 30 days of hating yourself



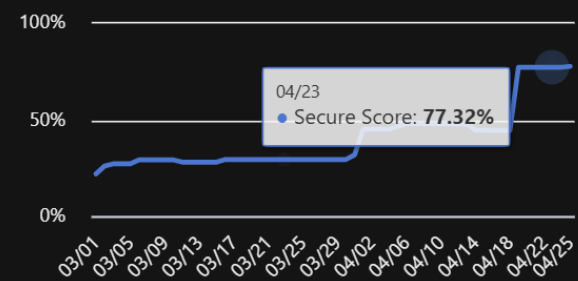
DEMO

Microsoft Secure Score

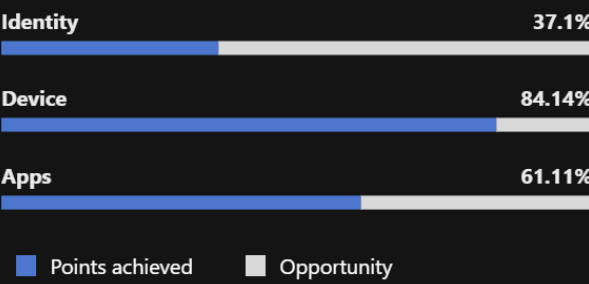
Your secure score Include ▾

Secure Score: 77.75%

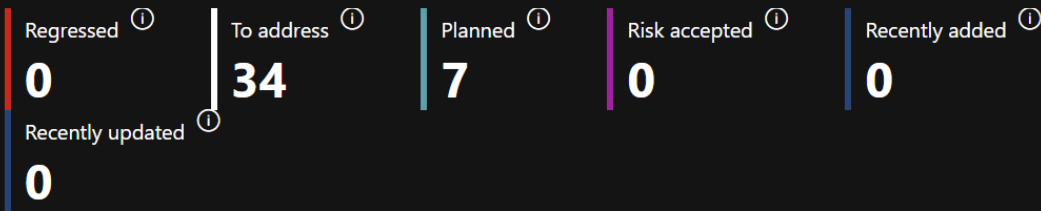
725.44/933 points achieved



Breakdown points by: Category ▾



Actions to review



Top recommended actions

Recommended action	Score impact	Status	Category
Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users...	+1.07%	☐ Planned	Identity
Enable Microsoft Defender Antivirus email scanning	+0.96%	☐ To address	Device
Block process creations originating from PSEXEC and W...	+0.96%	☐ To address	Device
Resume BitLocker protection on all drives	+0.96%	☐ To address	Device
Ensure multifactor authentication is enabled for all users	+0.96%	☐ Planned	Identity
Set controlled folder access to enabled or audit mode	+0.86%	☐ To address	Device



DEMO



Endpoint security | Attack surface reduction

[+ Create Policy](#) [Refresh](#) [Export](#)

Search by profile name

Policy name	↑↓	Policy type	↑↓	Assigned	↑↓	Platform	↑↓	Target	↑↓	Last modified	↑↓
Block abuse of exploited \		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:15 AM	...
Block Adobe Reader from		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 7:49 AM	...
Block all Office applicatio		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:11 AM	...
Block executable content		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:17 AM	...
Block executable files for		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:12 AM	...
Block execution of potent		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:21 AM	...
Block JavaScript or VBScri		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:10 AM	...
Block Office applications		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:14 AM	...
Block Office applications		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:23 AM	...
Block Office communicati		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:20 AM	...
Block persistence throug		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:18 AM	...
Block process creations o		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:19 AM	...
Block rebooting machine		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:21 AM	...
Block untrusted and unsig		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:16 AM	...
Block use of copied or im		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:22 AM	...
Block Win32 API calls for		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:13 AM	...
Controlled folder access		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 2:53 PM	...
Use advanced protection		Attack Surface Reductio...		Yes		Windows		MDM, MicrosoftSense		04/20/26, 8:40 AM	...

Enable 'Network Protection'

● Remediation required

Block process creations originating from PSEXec and WMI commands

● Remediation required

[Open software page](#) [Report inaccuracy](#)

Enable Microsoft Defender Antivirus email scanning

● Remediation required

[Open software page](#) [Report inaccuracy](#)

General Remediation options Exposed devices

Description

Determines whether Microsoft Defender Antivirus analyzes the mail bodies and attachments and scans them for malicious content. MDMWinsOverGP configuration is not supported.

[Assess devices against industry standard benchmarks like CIS. Try for free](#)

Potential risk

Not scanning incoming emails and attachments could potentially enable attackers to deliver malicious content and attachments into the organization

Recommendation insights

- No devices in your organization are configured as recommended
- This configuration is recommended by the following benchmarks: MS, CIS, STIG

[Assess devices against industry standard benchmarks like CIS. Try for free](#)

[Get more insights into how well your organization is protected against ransomware in exposure management.](#)

Related threats

Details

Tags

-

Category

Security controls (Antivirus)

Configuration ID

scid-90

Exposed devices

1 / 1

Devices pending restart

0 / 1

Impact

▼ 0.00 | + 9.00

Exposed operating systems

Windows 11

Details

Tags

Human operated ransomware +1

Category

Security controls (Attack Surface Reduction)

Configuration ID

scid-2510

Exposed devices

1 / 1

Devices pending restart

0 / 1

Impact

▼ 0.00 | + 9.00

Exposed operating systems

Windows 11

CCE

Details

Tags

-

Category

Network

Configuration ID

scid-96

Exposed devices

1 / 1

Devices pending restart

0 / 1

Impact

▼ 0.00 | + 8.00

Exposed operating systems

Windows 11

CCE

N/A



Microsoft Entra admin center

Home > Users

Users | User settings

Contoso

Refresh | Got feedback?

- All users
- Audit logs
- Sign-in logs
- Diagnose and solve problems
- Deleted users
- Password reset
- User settings**
- Bulk operation results
- Bulk operation results (Preview)
- New support request

Default user role permissions

[Learn more](#)

Users can register applications ☒ Yes ☐ No

Restrict non-admin users from creating tenants ☒ Yes ☐ No

Users can create security groups ☒ Yes ☐ No

Guest user access

[Learn more](#)

Guest user access restrictions ☐ Guest users have the same access as members (most in... ☒ Guest users have limited access to properties and mem... ☐ Guest user access is restricted to properties and memb...

Administration center

[Learn more](#)

Restrict access to Microsoft Entra admin center ☒ Yes ☐ No

LinkedIn account connections

[Learn more](#)

Allow users to connect their ☐ Yes ☒ No

Save Cancel

Contoso Electronics Microsoft Defender

Microsoft Secure Score

Overview **Recommended actions** History Metrics & trends

Export

Rank	Recommended action
13	Set 'Reset account lockout counter after' to 15 minutes or more
14	Set 'Account lockout duration' to 15 minutes or more
☒ 15	Ensure third party integrated applications are not allowed
16	Ensure Sign-in frequency is enabled and browser sessions a
17	Ensure the admin consent workflow is enabled
18	Ensure custom banned passwords lists are used
19	Set 'Minimum PIN length for startup' to '6 or more characte
20	Set user authentication for remote connections by using Ne
21	Disable 'Installation and configuration of Network Bridge o
22	Enable Automatic Updates
23	Enable 'Hide Option to Enable or Disable Updates'
24	Disable the local storage of passwords and credentials

Ensure third party integrated applications are not allowed

Edit status & action plan Manage tags

General Implementation **History (1)**

View changes to this recommended action. "Ensure third party integrated applications are not allowed".

Point changes over time

0 04/22

Score

Activity

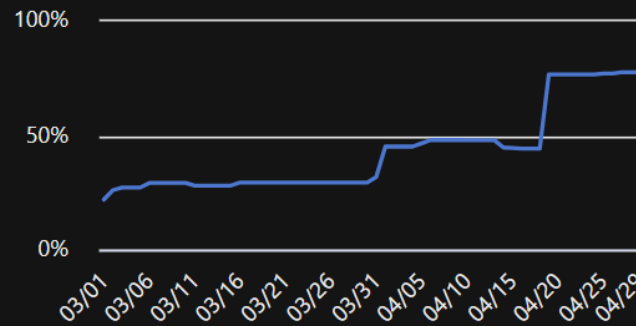
Date	Change
04/22	MOD Administrator marked this action as planned

Manage in Microsoft Entra ID Share

Microsoft Secure Score

Secure Score: **77.73%**

752.44/968 points achieved



Breakdown points by: Category

Identity 37.1%

Device 83.84%

Apps 61.11%

Points achieved Opportunity



Follow-On Sessions

A silhouette of a cowboy wearing a hat, standing in water and swinging a lasso. The lasso is a large loop that extends from the cowboy's hand up towards the top right of the slide, framing the title area.

Carrie Cook & Jordan Benzing

- ♦ **Mastering Microsoft Entra Conditional Access: Secure Access with Precision**

Description:

Microsoft Entra Conditional Access enhances app and data security by evaluating real-time signals, including user risk, device compliance, and location. Build policies that enforce multifactor authentication, block risky sign-ins, and implement adaptive controls. Gain practical strategies for designing effective policies aligned with Zero Trust principles, ensuring secure access while maintaining user productivity in both cloud and hybrid environments.

Time Slot – Wednesday, May 6 at 1pm

Rod Trent & Ewelina Paczkowska

- ♦ **Real-World Insights from Microsoft Purview Implementations**

Description:

Implementing Microsoft Purview effectively can be complex, with common challenges often arising during deployments. Discover hard-earned lessons that highlight what consistently works, common pitfalls, and critical factors like stakeholder alignment and user adoption that drive success. Topics include achieving classification accuracy, designing effective policies, and enhancing operational maturity, providing actionable insights for successful Purview implementations in your own environments.

Time Slot – Wednesday, May 6 at 10:00am CST



Now onto other things..



SAVE THE DATES

Oct 25-28, 2026



May 2-6, 2027



Oct 10-13, 2027



Extended Q&A



2Pint

Recast

robopack
empowered by SOFTWARE
CENTRAL

SquaredUp

CODETWO

baramundi

ninjaOne

Rimo3



TeamViewer

numecent

aiden